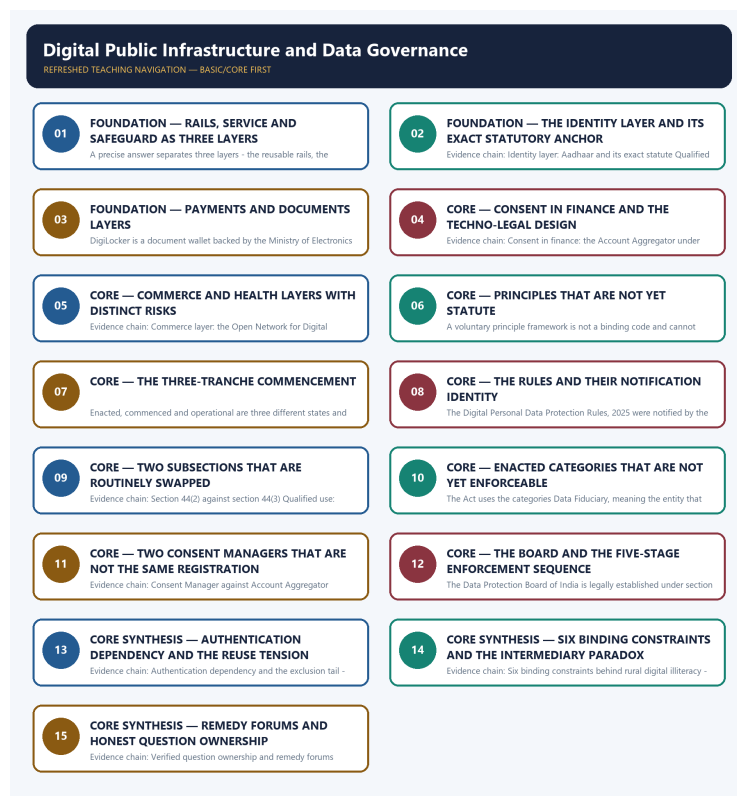


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Digital Public Infrastructure and Data Governance - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Digital public infrastructure defined against a service?

A. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. B. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. C. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. D. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Answer: A. Explanation: Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Digital public infrastructure defined against a service?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. C. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. D. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Answer: B. Explanation: Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. The remaining options belong to different

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Digital public infrastructure defined against a service?

A. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. B. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.

Answer: C. Explanation: Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Digital public infrastructure defined against a service?

A. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems.

Answer: D. Explanation: Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The three layers a digital-governance answer must keep apart?

A. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. D. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.

Answer: A. Explanation: A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The three layers a digital-governance answer must keep apart?

A. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. B. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. C. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. D. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.

Answer: B. Explanation: A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three layers a digital-governance answer must keep apart?

A. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: C. Explanation: A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three layers a digital-governance answer must keep apart?

A. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. B. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. C. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: D. Explanation: A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. The

remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Identity layer: Aadhaar and its exact statute?

A. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.

Answer: A. Explanation: Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Identity layer: Aadhaar and its exact statute?

A. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: B. Explanation: Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Identity layer: Aadhaar and its exact statute?

A. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. B. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. C. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Identity layer: Aadhaar and its exact statute?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. C. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. D. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Answer: D. Explanation: Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies,

benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Payments layer: the Unified Payments Interface?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Payments layer: the Unified Payments Interface?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Payments layer: the Unified Payments Interface?

A. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. B. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. C. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. D. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Payments layer: the Unified Payments Interface?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than

any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Documents layer: DigiLocker?

A. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. B. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. C. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. D. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework.

Answer: A. Explanation: DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Documents layer: DigiLocker?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: B. Explanation: DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Documents layer: DigiLocker?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. C. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: C. Explanation: DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Documents layer: DigiLocker?

A. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it.

Answer: D. Explanation: DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. The remaining options belong

to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Consent in finance: the Account Aggregator under DEPA?

A. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. B. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. C. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Consent in finance: the Account Aggregator under DEPA?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). D. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and

Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Consent in finance: the Account Aggregator under DEPA?

A. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: C. Explanation: The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Consent in finance: the Account Aggregator under DEPA?

A. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). D. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Commerce layer: the Open Network for Digital Commerce?

A. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. B. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other

than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: A. Explanation: The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Commerce layer: the Open Network for Digital Commerce?

A. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. B. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: B. Explanation: The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Commerce layer: the Open Network for Digital Commerce?

A. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). C. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. D. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023

substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Commerce layer: the Open Network for Digital Commerce?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Health layer: the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission?

A. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and

sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Health layer: the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission?

A. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. B. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Health layer: the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional

challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Health layer: the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. C. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Techno-legal design and non-statutory principle frameworks?

A. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: A. Explanation: Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Techno-legal design and non-statutory principle frameworks?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information

exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Techno-legal design and non-statutory principle frameworks?

A. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. D. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today.

Answer: C. Explanation: Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Techno-legal design and non-statutory principle frameworks?

A. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. B. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. C. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. D. Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body.

Answer: D. Explanation: Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The three-tranche commencement of the data-protection statute?

A. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted,

commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The three-tranche commencement of the data-protection statute?

A. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). C. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(a); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(a), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three-tranche commencement of the data-protection statute?

A. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. B. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13

November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). D. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(a); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(a), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three-tranche commencement of the data-protection statute?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. C. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

Answer: D. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The Rules and their notification identity?

A. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. B. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. C. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. D. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The Rules and their notification identity?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. C. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. D. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Rules and their notification identity?

A. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. B. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. C. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. D. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Rules and their notification identity?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. C. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. D. The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became

fully operative on enactment or on notification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Section 44(2) against section 44(3)?

A. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. B. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. C. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. D. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Section 44(2) against section 44(3)?

A. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. B. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. C. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. D. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Section 44(2) against section 44(3)?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. C. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. D. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Section 44(2) against section 44(3)?

A. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. B. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. C. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote

areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. D. Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Enacted categories that are not yet enforceable?

A. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. B. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. C. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. D. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Enacted categories that are not yet enforceable?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. C. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Enacted categories that are not yet enforceable?

A. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. B. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. C. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. D. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Enacted categories that are not yet enforceable?

A. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. B. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. C. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. D. The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Consent Manager against Account Aggregator?

A. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. B. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. C. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture

is sound. D. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Consent Manager against Account Aggregator?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. C. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Consent Manager against Account Aggregator?

A. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. B. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. C. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Consent Manager against Account Aggregator?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. C. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those

constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. D. The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The Board and the enforcement sequence?

A. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. B. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. C. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. D. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under The Board and the enforcement sequence?

A. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. B. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. C. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Board and the enforcement sequence?

A. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. B. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. C. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020

demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Board and the enforcement sequence?

A. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Authentication dependency and the exclusion tail?

A. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. B. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. C. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: A. Explanation: The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Authentication dependency and the exclusion tail?

A. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. B. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department

and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. D. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.

Answer: B. Explanation: The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Authentication dependency and the exclusion tail?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. C. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. D. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems.

Answer: C. Explanation: The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. The

remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Authentication dependency and the exclusion tail?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. C. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. D. The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Answer: D. Explanation: The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Interoperability against purpose limitation?

A. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. B. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. C. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error,

which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator.

Answer: A. Explanation: The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Interoperability against purpose limitation?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person.

Answer: B. Explanation: The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability

and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Interoperability against purpose limitation?

A. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. C. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: C. Explanation: The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Interoperability against purpose limitation?

A. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification,

payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.

Answer: D. Explanation: The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Six binding constraints behind rural digital illiteracy?

A. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. C. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. D. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Six binding constraints behind rural digital illiteracy?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Six binding constraints behind rural digital illiteracy?

A. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy

converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Six binding constraints behind rural digital illiteracy?

A. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. B. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. C. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. D. Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The intermediary paradox and the four safeguards?

A. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. B. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: A. Explanation: Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The intermediary paradox and the four safeguards?

A. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. B. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. C. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. D. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and

application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems.

Answer: B. Explanation: Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The intermediary paradox and the four safeguards?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. D. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.

Answer: C. Explanation: Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The intermediary paradox and the four safeguards?

A. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. C. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the

payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. D. Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person.

Answer: D. Explanation: Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified question ownership and remedy forums?

A. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. B. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. C. Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. D. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent

dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified question ownership and remedy forums?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. C. A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. D. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified question ownership and remedy forums?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction

a routed objective demand tests. C. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. D. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified question ownership and remedy forums?

A. The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. B. DigiLocker is a document wallet backed by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology that lets a citizen hold and share issuer-verified documents such as certificates and licences electronically with government and other agencies, and its reach depends on issuers digitising records at source, so the wallet cannot be better than the registers that feed it. C. The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. D. The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board

only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

One direct General Studies Paper-II Mains demand is routed to this topic across the audited ledgers, and its printed stem was confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official question paper. The audited 2018-2023 ledger routes the 2021 demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so it is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers additionally route five objective demands to this owner: the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof with deactivation rules, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and mandatory linkage rules, the 2022 demand on Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission provisions, the 2022 demand on government digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. For the 2018, 2020 and 2022 objective demands the official key is not held locally; for the 2024 objective demand an official Set-A answer key is present in the repository. In every case no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred here, and each objective demand is treated only as a statement-level coverage requirement. Because only one Mains demand is directly routed to this owner, the remaining solved cards below are the routed demands from immediately adjacent owners that this file supplies the necessary infrastructure and data-governance material for; each card states its own ledger routing rather than claiming verbatim ownership. No official answer key or marking scheme is held locally for any routed Mains demand, so every model solution below is an authored answer route rather than an official key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the governance demand in “VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the governance concept and separate it from the nearest legal, institutional or measured category. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, delegated or executive authority and the competent level of government. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline

implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map state, market, civil-society, frontline and citizen stakeholders with power, duty and vulnerability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace finance, information, implementation, monitoring, grievance, appeal and correction through the delivery chain. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, institution, scheme, audit, reform or local example with source, date and operative status. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test exclusion, digital divide, privacy, capture, capacity, indicator gaming, trade-off and residual-risk limits. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No GS-II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers names DPI or the DPDP Act directly, but this file's identity/payments/consent-data framework is the necessary background for any e-governance (05) or citizen-centric administration (07) question that references digital service infrastructure, and for any Polity-linked privacy question (Puttaswamy) that intersects with data-protection law.

- ANALYSIS: Use the DPI-vs-e-governance distinction as a precise opening move whenever a question conflates "digital India" broadly with a specific service-delivery platform.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	98	Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	12	Aadhaar card as citizenship proof and deactivation rules	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	1	Aadhaar data storage and mandatory linkage rules	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	19	Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission health coverage provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	31	Government digital services built on open-source platforms	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Aadhaar card as citizenship proof and deactivation rules
- Aadhaar data storage and mandatory linkage rules
- Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission health coverage provisions

- Government digital services built on open-source platforms

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Where a question links e-governance/DPI to transparency or accountability (echoing the 2024 e-governance PYQ, see 05), use this file's layered-risk framework to show that "transparency" at the DPI layer (visible identity/consent flows) does not automatically resolve exclusion or consent-quality problems - a useful analytical extension beyond the e-governance-specific PYQ answer.
- ANALYSIS: Where a question invites comparison with global data-protection regimes, use the Data Fiduciary/Data Principal terminology and the Consent Manager mechanism as India-specific design features to discuss, rather than assuming identical structure to other countries' frameworks.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-II	16	Digital illiteracy in rural areas and access to information	Examine with justification · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; printed stem partly truncated in scan	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Digital illiteracy in rural areas and access to information

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: Has digital illiteracy, particularly in rural areas, coupled with lack of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) accessibility hindered socio-economic development? Examine with justification. Answer in 250 words for 15 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner as the single direct Mains demand for this topic, answered from the Basic owner under core routing, and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2021 General Studies Paper-II, where the printed stem is partly truncated in the scan. No official answer key is held locally.

Model solution: Examine with justification requires a defended position rather than a survey, so open by reframing the question precisely: the barrier is not one deficit called digital illiteracy but a stack of separable constraints, and an answer that says literacy is low cannot be examined because it names nothing that can be fixed. Take the position that digital illiteracy and access gaps have hindered socio-economic development, but through a specific mechanism rather than in general. Disaggregate into six binding constraints, keeping each distinct. Device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member, so the person who needs the service is not the person who holds the device. Connectivity quality and cost, which is a different problem from coverage, because a signal that drops mid-transaction fails a payment or an authentication. Language and script, and critically the error messages, which is where translation usually stops. Functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task

rather than to operate a phone. Trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use even where capability exists. Authentication failure from worn fingerprints, address mismatch or a connectivity drop. Now state the governance consequence that carries the marks: as services migrate online, digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, because the digital route becomes the only route, and the entitlement is lost not by a decision but by a design. Add the intersectional layer, since the same village produces very different effective access by gender, age and disability once device control, mobility and social permission are considered. Then supply the intermediary paradox as the highest-value point: assisted access through a service centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic solution and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove. Justify the position with correctives that follow from the constraints - assisted-access channels with published fees, vernacular interfaces including error text, offline and low-bandwidth fallback, reasoned rejection, a human appeal that does not require the failed digital step, and a duty to provide a non-digital alternative for entitlements. Conclude with the design obligation reversed: digital literacy is a necessary investment, but a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user rather than by the trained one. Cite no internet-penetration, digital-literacy or mission-coverage figure.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper-II”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Examine with justification requires a defended position rather than a survey, so open by reframing the question precisely: the barrier is not one deficit called digital illiteracy but a stack of separable constraints, and an answer that says literacy is low cannot be examined because it names nothing that can be fixed. Take the position that digital illiteracy and access gaps have hindered socio-economic development, but through a specific mechanism rather than in general. Disaggregate into six binding constraints, keeping each distinct. Device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member, so the person who needs the service is not the person who holds the device. Connectivity quality and cost, which is a different problem from coverage, because a signal that drops mid-transaction fails a payment or an authentication. Language and script, and critically the error messages, which is where translation usually stops. Functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone. Trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use even where capability exists. Authentication failure from worn fingerprints, address mismatch or a connectivity drop. Now state the governance consequence that carries the marks: as services migrate online, digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, because the digital route becomes the only route, and the entitlement is lost not by a decision but by a design. Add the intersectional layer, since the same village produces very different effective access by gender, age and disability once device control, mobility and social permission are considered. Then supply the intermediary paradox as the highest-value point: assisted access through a service centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic solution and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove. Justify the position with correctives that follow from the constraints - assisted-access channels with published fees, vernacular interfaces including error text, offline and low-bandwidth fallback, reasoned rejection, a human appeal that does not require the failed digital step, and a duty to provide a non-digital alternative for entitlements. Conclude with the design obligation reversed: digital literacy is a necessary investment, but a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user rather than by the trained one. Cite no internet-penetration, digital-literacy or mission-coverage figure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Examine with justification requires a defended position rather than a survey, so open by reframing the question precisely: the barrier is not one deficit called digital illiteracy but a stack of separable constraints, and an answer that says literacy is low cannot be examined because it names nothing that can be fixed. Take the position that digital illiteracy and access gaps have hindered socio-economic development, but through a specific mechanism rather than in general. Disaggregate into six binding constraints, keeping each distinct. Device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member, so the person who needs the service is not the person who holds the device. Connectivity quality and cost, which is a different problem from coverage, because a signal that drops mid-transaction fails a payment or an authentication. Language and script, and critically the error messages, which is where translation usually stops. Functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone. Trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use even where capability exists. Authentication failure from worn fingerprints, address mismatch or a connectivity drop. Now state the governance consequence that carries the marks: as services migrate online, digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, because the digital route becomes the only route, and the entitlement is lost not by a decision but by a design. Add the intersectional layer, since the same village produces very different effective access by gender, age and disability once device control, mobility and social permission are considered. Then supply the intermediary paradox as the highest-value point: assisted access through a service centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic solution and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove. Justify the position with correctives that follow from the constraints - assisted-access channels with published fees, vernacular interfaces including error text, offline and low-bandwidth fallback, reasoned rejection, a human appeal that does not require the failed digital step, and a duty to provide a non-digital alternative for entitlements. Conclude with the design obligation reversed: digital literacy is a necessary investment, but a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user rather than by the trained one. Cite no internet-penetration, digital-literacy or mission-coverage figure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. Objective question routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2024-2025 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. An official Set-A answer key is present in the repository for this year, and no option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred here; the demand is treated only as a statement-level coverage requirement.

Model solution: This is an objective demand and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the statement-level distinction the question family tests, namely that a land-records modernisation programme is a service and record-digitisation initiative rather than a component of the identity, payments or consent rails, that record digitisation at source is the precondition on which any document-wallet or single-window service depends, and that digitising a defective register produces a confident wrong output rather than a corrected record. Retain the layer discipline as the revision anchor: rails, service and safeguard are three different objects, and a land-records programme sits in the service and records layer while depending on the identity layer for authentication. Assert no coverage percentage, State ranking, survey status or completion figure for the programme, and record no answer letter, because the presence of an official key in the repository does not license importing an answer into a learning package.

Demand decoding: Treat "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper-I" as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: This is an objective demand and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the statement-level distinction the question family tests, namely that a land-records modernisation programme is a service and record-digitisation initiative rather than a component of the identity, payments or consent rails, that record digitisation at source is the precondition on which any document-wallet or single-window service depends, and that digitising a defective register produces a confident wrong output rather than a corrected record. Retain the layer discipline as the revision anchor: rails, service and safeguard are three different objects, and a land-records programme sits in the service and records layer while depending on the identity layer for authentication. Assert no coverage percentage, State ranking, survey status or completion figure for the programme, and record no answer letter, because the presence of an official key in the repository does not license importing an answer into a learning package.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. Objective question routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: This is an objective demand and is deliberately not converted into a solved answer. What the owner must supply is the statement-level distinction the question family tests, namely that a land-records modernisation programme is a service and record-digitisation initiative rather than a component of the identity, payments or consent rails, that record digitisation at source is the precondition on which any document-wallet or single-window service depends, and that digitising a defective register produces a confident wrong output rather than a corrected record. Retain the layer discipline as the revision anchor: rails, service and safeguard are three different objects, and a land-records programme sits in the service and records layer while depending on the identity layer for authentication. Assert no coverage percentage, State ranking, survey status or completion figure for the programme, and record no answer letter, because the presence of an official key in the repository does not license importing an answer into a learning package.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper-I", state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission health coverage provisions, and government digital services built on open-source platforms. Two objective questions routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. The official keys for that year are not held locally, so no option or answer has been inferred, and one of the two stems was verified against the official scan with an optical-character-recognition artefact resolved.

Model solution: Both demands are objective and are not converted into solved answers. The coverage requirement is the precise architecture of the health mission and the precise meaning of an open-protocol public digital service. For

the health mission, retain that it is administered by the National Health Authority, that the Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier is voluntary, that the mission maintains health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange so that records follow the patient, and that it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person; a health-insurance benefit and a digital-health architecture are also distinct programmes and must not be merged in a statement-level question. For open-protocol services, retain that the design claim is interoperability and reduced platform lock-in through open standards and application programming interfaces rather than a claim about the licensing of any particular software product, and that the governance risk of an open commerce protocol is market-design fairness rather than data exclusion. Assert no adoption, enrolment, record or transaction figure for either, and record no answer letter.

Demand decoding: Treat “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 Prelims General Studies Paper-I” as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Both demands are objective and are not converted into solved answers. The coverage requirement is the precise architecture of the health mission and the precise meaning of an open-protocol public digital service. For the health mission, retain that it is administered by the National Health Authority, that the Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier is voluntary, that the mission maintains health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange so that records follow the patient, and that it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person; a health-insurance benefit and a digital-health architecture are also distinct programmes and must not be merged in a statement-level question. For open-protocol services, retain that the design claim is interoperability and reduced platform lock-in through open standards and application programming interfaces rather than a claim about the licensing of any particular software product, and that the governance risk of an open commerce protocol is market-design fairness rather than data exclusion. Assert no adoption, enrolment, record or transaction figure for either, and record no answer letter.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission health coverage provisions, and government digital services built on open-source platforms. Two objective questions routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Both demands are objective and are not converted into solved answers. The coverage requirement is the precise architecture of the health mission and the precise meaning of an open-protocol public digital service. For the health mission, retain that it is administered by the National Health Authority, that the Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier is voluntary, that the mission maintains health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange so that records follow the patient, and that it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person; a health-insurance benefit and a digital-health architecture are also distinct programmes and must not be merged in a statement-level question. For open-protocol services, retain that the design claim is interoperability and reduced platform lock-in through open standards and application programming interfaces rather than a claim about the licensing of any particular software product, and that the governance risk of an open commerce protocol is market-design fairness rather than data exclusion. Assert no adoption, enrolment, record or transaction figure for either, and record no answer letter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or

tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 Prelims General Studies Paper-I”, state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Aadhaar card as citizenship proof and deactivation rules. Objective question routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. The official key for that year is not held locally, so no option or answer has been inferred.

Model solution: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the single distinction the question family repeatedly tests: the number is issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India as an identity and residence-linked identifier used for targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services, and it is not proof of citizenship. Keep the associated statement-level anchors precise and bounded - enrolment, authentication and the statutory purpose of targeted delivery are what the statute names - and do not import an eligibility, deactivation or cancellation rule that the repository owner does not carry. Assert no enrolment, authentication-failure or deactivation figure, and record no answer letter.

Demand decoding: Treat “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper-I” as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the single distinction the question family repeatedly tests: the number is issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India as an identity and residence-linked identifier used for targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services, and it is not proof of citizenship. Keep the associated statement-level anchors precise and bounded - enrolment, authentication and the statutory purpose of targeted delivery are what the statute names - and do not import an eligibility, deactivation or cancellation rule that the repository owner does not carry. Assert no enrolment, authentication-failure or deactivation figure, and record no answer letter.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Aadhaar card as citizenship proof and deactivation rules. Objective question routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. The official key for that year is not held locally, so no option or answer has been inferred. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is the single distinction the question family repeatedly tests: the number is issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India as an identity and residence-linked identifier used for targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services, and it is not proof of citizenship. Keep the associated statement-level anchors precise and bounded - enrolment, authentication and the statutory purpose of targeted delivery are what the statute names - and do not import an eligibility, deactivation or cancellation rule that the repository owner does not carry. Assert no enrolment, authentication-failure or deactivation figure, and record no answer letter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper-I”, state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2020 Prelims General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Aadhaar data storage and mandatory linkage rules. Objective question routed to this owner.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. The official key for that year is not held locally, so no option or answer has been inferred.

Model solution: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is that identity infrastructure raises three separable statement-level issues that a close-option question exploits - what the statute authorises, what a rule or executive instruction requires, and what a court has permitted or restricted - and that a learning package must not merge them. Retain the layer discipline instead: the identity layer supplies verification, the consent layer supplies controlled sharing, and the data-protection statute supplies the duties and rights whose substantive parts commence on 13 May 2027, so a claim about mandatory linkage must be tied to the instrument that imposes it and to the date on which that instrument operates. Assert no linkage deadline, storage specification, seeding percentage or enforcement statistic, and record no answer letter.

Demand decoding: Treat “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2020 Prelims General Studies Paper-I” as an authority, mandate, jurisdiction, process, indicator and source-date-status problem; test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is that identity infrastructure raises three separable statement-level issues that a close-option question exploits - what the statute authorises, what a rule or executive instruction requires, and what a court has permitted or restricted - and that a learning package must not merge them. Retain the layer discipline instead: the identity layer supplies verification, the consent layer supplies controlled sharing, and the data-protection statute supplies the duties and rights whose substantive parts commence on 13 May 2027, so a claim about mandatory linkage must be tied to the instrument that imposes it and to the date on which that instrument operates. Assert no linkage deadline, storage specification, seeding percentage or enforcement statistic, and record no answer letter.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2020 Prelims General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Aadhaar data storage and mandatory linkage rules. Objective question routed to this owner. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Prelims ledger to this Basic owner. The official key for that year is not held locally, so no option or answer has been inferred. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The demand is objective and is not converted into a solved answer. The coverage requirement is that identity infrastructure raises three separable statement-level issues that a close-option question exploits - what the statute authorises, what a rule or executive instruction requires, and what a court has permitted or restricted - and that a learning package must not merge them. Retain the layer discipline instead: the identity layer supplies verification, the consent layer supplies controlled sharing, and the data-protection statute supplies the duties and rights whose substantive parts commence on 13 May 2027, so a claim about mandatory linkage must be tied to the instrument that imposes it and to the date on which that instrument operates. Assert no linkage deadline, storage specification, seeding percentage or enforcement statistic, and record no answer letter.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the legal or institutional category; map the competent level; separate instrument from outcome; eliminate the nearest mandate, implementation, chronology, privacy or tournament-body distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar scheme, institution or recommendation from being mistaken for implemented law, proven outcome or wider jurisdiction.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2020 Prelims General Studies Paper-I", state precisely why the closest distractor fails on authority, level, process stage, indicator, source, date or status.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish digital public infrastructure from e-governance with Indian examples and explain why the distinction changes the governance question. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Rails are reusable and cross-sectoral while a service is departmental, so the distinction converts a complaint about one portal into the systemic questions of interoperability, exclusion and concentration that the infrastructure layer actually raises.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems.
- A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here.
- Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests.

Qualified conclusion: Rails are reusable and cross-sectoral while a service is departmental, so the distinction converts a complaint about one portal into the systemic questions of interoperability, exclusion and concentration that the infrastructure layer actually raises.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Distinguish digital public infrastructure from e-governance with Indian examples and explain...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Rails are reusable and cross-sectoral while a service is departmental, so the distinction converts a complaint about one portal into the systemic questions of interoperability, exclusion and concentration that the infrastructure layer actually raises.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Digital public infrastructure means the foundational, interoperable digital systems built on open standards and application programming interfaces that enable identity verification, payments and consent-based data sharing at population scale for both government and private actors, and it is often called the India Stack; a specific departmental portal is a service built on those rails, so infrastructure and service are different objects with different governance problems. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A precise answer separates three layers - the reusable rails, the specific service delivered on them, and the legal safeguard framework that governs the data they move - because collapsing them turns a systemic problem of interoperability, exclusion and concentration into a departmental complaint; the constitutional right-to-privacy foundation in Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India is owned by the Polity fundamental-rights material and is cross-linked rather than re-derived here. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Aadhaar is a twelve-digit unique identity number issued under the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 and administered by the Unique Identification Authority of India, and it is used for identity verification and the targeted delivery of subsidies, benefits and services; it is an identity and residence-linked number and is not proof of citizenship, which is the exact distinction a routed objective demand tests. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Rails are reusable and cross-sectoral while a service is departmental, so the distinction converts a complaint about one portal into the systemic questions of interoperability, exclusion and concentration that the infrastructure layer actually raises.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish digital public infrastructure from e-governance with Indian examples and explain...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the governance risks arising at different layers of India's digital public infrastructure stack.

Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Each layer generates its own distinct risk - authentication exclusion, connectivity exclusion, self-service literacy, consent quality, market-design fairness and sensitive-data safeguarding - so treating them as one undifferentiated privacy concern collapses problems that need different correctives.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here.
- The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried by the identity layer.
- The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny.
- The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.

Qualified conclusion: Each layer generates its own distinct risk - authentication exclusion, connectivity exclusion, self-service literacy, consent quality, market-design fairness and sensitive-data safeguarding - so treating them as one undifferentiated privacy concern collapses problems that need different correctives.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish the governance risks arising at different layers of India's digital public...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Each layer generates its own distinct risk - authentication exclusion, connectivity exclusion, self-service literacy, consent quality, market-design fairness and sensitive-data safeguarding - so treating them as one undifferentiated privacy concern collapses problems that need different correctives.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Unified Payments Interface is a real-time interoperable retail payment system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India that enables instant bank-to-bank transfer and forms the payments layer of the stack, and its governance value is interoperability at population scale rather than any transaction or user figure, none of which is asserted here. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Open Network for Digital Commerce is an open-protocol initiative backed by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade that enables buyers and sellers to transact across platforms and reduces platform lock-in, and its central governance risk is market-design fairness, meaning whether smaller sellers obtain genuinely equal visibility, which is qualitatively different from the data-exclusion risk carried

by the identity layer. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is the digital-health architecture of the National Health Authority, built around the voluntary Ayushman Bharat Health Account identifier, health-professional and facility registries and consent-mediated exchange of records so that records can follow the patient; it does not create one central government-owned clinical record for every person, and health data carries higher re-identification and discrimination risk than payment data, so it requires sector-specific scrutiny. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Each layer generates its own distinct risk - authentication exclusion, connectivity exclusion, self-service literacy, consent quality, market-design fairness and sensitive-data safeguarding - so treating them as one undifferentiated privacy concern collapses problems that need different correctives.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish the governance risks arising at different layers of India's digital public...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine whether digital illiteracy in rural areas, coupled with limited access to information and communication technology, has hindered socio-economic development. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Digital illiteracy is a stack of six separable constraints rather than a single deficit, and its developmental damage arises at the moment the digital route becomes the only route, so the design obligation runs the other way and a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy

converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.

- Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person.
- The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix.
- The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error.

Qualified conclusion: Digital illiteracy is a stack of six separable constraints rather than a single deficit, and its developmental damage arises at the moment the digital route becomes the only route, so the design obligation runs the other way and a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine whether digital illiteracy in rural areas, coupled with limited access to information...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Digital illiteracy is a stack of six separable constraints rather than a single deficit, and its developmental damage arises at the moment the digital route becomes the only route, so the design obligation runs the other way and a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Rural digital exclusion is a stack of six distinct constraints rather than one deficit - device access and sharing, where a single household handset is controlled by one member; connectivity quality and cost rather than mere coverage; language and script, especially of error messages; functional digital literacy, meaning the ability to complete a task rather than to operate a phone; trust and fear of error, which suppresses independent use; and authentication failure - and the governance consequence is that as services migrate online digital illiteracy converts from an inconvenience into an access denial, with device control, mobility and social permission producing very different effective access by gender, age and disability within the same village.
Analysis: Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness

or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The presence-less, paperless and cashless design goal is the structural reason the stack reduces transaction cost, but each removed friction was also somebody's fallback, and once access is conditional on successful verification a small but real share of users - manual workers with worn fingerprints, remote areas with intermittent connectivity, records with an address mismatch - are excluded precisely where the system was meant to include; an offline or manual override mitigates this and reintroduces some of the discretion the design was meant to remove, so it is a genuine trade-off rather than a costless fix. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Digital illiteracy is a stack of six separable constraints rather than a single deficit, and its developmental damage arises at the moment the digital route becomes the only route, so the design obligation runs the other way and a public service must be usable by the least-capable eligible user.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine whether digital illiteracy in rural areas, coupled with limited access to information...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the adequacy of India's current data-protection framework as a safeguard for its digital public infrastructure. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: India built the rails before it commenced the safeguards, so the honest verdict is that the architecture is world-scale while the protection framework is enacted, notified and substantially not yet in force, and the assessment must be written with sections, tranches and dates rather than with adjectives.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2).

- The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification.
- The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today.
- The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.

Qualified conclusion: India built the rails before it commenced the safeguards, so the honest verdict is that the architecture is world-scale while the protection framework is enacted, notified and substantially not yet in force, and the assessment must be written with sections, tranches and dates rather than with adjectives.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine the adequacy of India's current data-protection framework as a safeguard for its...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India built the rails before it commenced the safeguards, so the honest verdict is that the architecture is world-scale while the protection framework is enacted, notified and substantially not yet in force, and the assessment must be written with sections, tranches and dates rather than with adjectives.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 commences in three tranches under the notification G.S.R. 843(E) of 13 November 2025 - immediately, covering section 1(2), the section 2 definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and section 44(3); at twelve months on 13 November 2026, covering section 6(9) on consent managers and section 27(1)(d); and at eighteen months on 13 May 2027, covering sections 3 to 5, the remainder of section 6, sections 7 to 17 including Data Principal rights, sections 27 to 34 other than section 27(1)(d), sections 36 and 37 and section 44(2). **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology as G.S.R. 846(E) on 13 November 2025, with a corrigendum issued as G.S.R. 892(E) on 11 December 2025, and they operationalise the Act on the same phased schedule, so a compliance claim must cite the rule, the tranche and the date rather than asserting that the statute became fully operative on enactment or on notification. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Act uses the categories Data Fiduciary, meaning the entity that determines the purpose and means of processing, and Data Principal, meaning the individual to whom the personal data relates, in place of the controller and subject terminology used in some other jurisdictions, and most of the corresponding duties and rights commence only on 13 May 2027, so enacted, commenced and operational are three separate states and a right that is on the statute book must not be presented as enforceable today. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect ->

accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: India built the rails before it commenced the safeguards, so the honest verdict is that the architecture is world-scale while the protection framework is enacted, notified and substantially not yet in force, and the assessment must be written with sections, tranches and dates rather than with adjectives.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine the adequacy of India’s current data-protection framework as a safeguard for its...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the claim that the interoperability logic of digital public infrastructure is in structural tension with the purpose-limitation principle of data-protection law. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The tension is genuine and unresolved rather than a drafting oversight, because reuse is the value proposition of the rails and restraint on reuse is the core of the safeguard, so reconciliation depends on granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging and minimisation rather than on assuming compatibility.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound.
- The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework.
- The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error.

- Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body.

Qualified conclusion: The tension is genuine and unresolved rather than a drafting oversight, because reuse is the value proposition of the rails and restraint on reuse is the core of the safeguard, so reconciliation depends on granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging and minimisation rather than on assuming compatibility.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the claim that the interoperability logic of digital public infrastructure is in...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The tension is genuine and unresolved rather than a drafting oversight, because reuse is the value proposition of the rails and restraint on reuse is the core of the safeguard, so reconciliation depends on granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging and minimisation rather than on assuming compatibility.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The stack is designed for cross-service reuse of the same identity and data rails while purpose limitation forbids silently reusing data collected for one purpose in another, so interoperability and purpose limitation pull in different directions and are reconciled only through granular, purpose-specific consent artefacts, purpose tagging and data minimisation rather than by assuming default compatibility; consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension, is the practical failure mode even where the technical architecture is sound. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Data Empowerment and Protection Architecture is a techno-legal architecture for consent-based data sharing, and its operational financial-sector implementation is the Account Aggregator ecosystem regulated by the Reserve Bank of India as a distinct non-banking financial company category; the Account Aggregator is a consent manager that facilitates sharing between financial-information providers and financial-information users while being technically incapable of viewing, storing or monetising the data it transmits, and any extension of the architecture to another sector must be verified under that sector's own framework. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Consent Manager under the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 is a registered, interoperable, general-purpose platform through which an individual may give, manage, review and withdraw consent across Data Fiduciaries, and it commences on 13 November 2026 under section 6(9), whereas the Account Aggregator is a finance-specific entity regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under the earlier consent architecture; they are conceptually parallel and legally distinct registrations, and conflating them is a high-frequency error. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Techno-legal regulation means the architecture itself makes misuse difficult rather than merely unlawful, as with a consent manager that cannot view the data it transmits, and the India AI Governance Guidelines released by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on 5 November 2025 under the title Enabling Safe and Trusted AI Innovation supply the current official principle anchor of trust, people

first, innovation over restraint, fairness and equity, accountability, understandability by design, and safety and sustainability; those guidelines are a non-statutory, voluntary-compliance framework rather than an artificial-intelligence statute or binding code, so neither architecture nor principles substitutes for an operative right and an enforcing body. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The tension is genuine and unresolved rather than a drafting oversight, because reuse is the value proposition of the rails and restraint on reuse is the core of the safeguard, so reconciliation depends on granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging and minimisation rather than on assuming compatibility.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the claim that the interoperability logic of digital public infrastructure is in...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how the accountability of a digitally mediated adverse decision should be secured in India. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Accountability survives digital mediation only where the citizen can know that a decision was automated, obtain a reason, reach a human reviewer and identify a public authority that owns the outcome, which is why routing and an operative enforcing body matter more than the sophistication of the architecture.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted.
- The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties.
- Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person.
- The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology accessibility to the Advanced owner. The

Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator.

Qualified conclusion: Accountability survives digital mediation only where the citizen can know that a decision was automated, obtain a reason, reach a human reviewer and identify a public authority that owns the outcome, which is why routing and an operative enforcing body matter more than the sophistication of the architecture.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess how the accountability of a digitally mediated adverse decision should be secured in...”, every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Accountability survives digital mediation only where the citizen can know that a decision was automated, obtain a reason, reach a human reviewer and identify a public authority that owns the outcome, which is why routing and an operative enforcing body matter more than the sophistication of the architecture.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Section 44(3) of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 substitutes section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005 and sits in the already-commenced immediate tranche, so the substituted personal-information exemption has been operative since 13 and 14 November 2025, while section 44(2) amends the Information Technology Act, 2000 and is deferred to 13 May 2027; constitutional challenges to the transparency amendment have been filed and, as of 13 August 2026, no final judgment was located, so the challenge is stated as pending and no outcome is asserted. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Data Protection Board of India is legally established under section 18 of the Act, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology invited applications in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members, and no appointment order was located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off, so establishment, appointment of members, procedure, commenced substantive duties and decided cases are five separate stages and the Board must not be described as hearing complaints, issuing rulings or imposing penalties. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Assisted access through a Common Service Centre, a shopkeeper or a family member is the realistic route for those constraints and simultaneously introduces a new intermediary with a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's credentials, reproducing the discretion that digitisation was meant to remove; four safeguards therefore attach to any infrastructure proposal - necessity and proportionality tested purpose by purpose, data minimisation with purpose tagging, an assisted and offline fallback preserved for entitlements, and reasoned human review and appeal so that an adverse automated outcome is explainable and contestable by a person. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger routes the 2021 General Studies Paper-II demand on digital illiteracy in rural areas coupled with a lack of information and communication technology

accessibility to the Advanced owner. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so that demand is answered from the core file. The audited Prelims ledgers route five objective demands to this owner, namely the 2018 demand on Aadhaar and citizenship proof, the 2020 demand on Aadhaar data storage and linkage, the 2022 demands on the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and on digital services built on open-source platforms, and the 2024 demand on the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme. No option, answer letter or distractor is recorded or inferred for any of them. Remedies also divide by forum rather than by seriousness. A service delay belongs to the department and the grievance platform, an information denial to the Information Commission, a personal-data breach to the Board only once its members are appointed and the relevant duties commence, a financial-data consent dispute to the regulated Account Aggregator framework, a health-record consent dispute to the health-mission architecture, and a sectoral service dispute to the sector regulator. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Accountability survives digital mediation only where the citizen can know that a decision was automated, obtain a reason, reach a human reviewer and identify a public authority that owns the outcome, which is why routing and an operative enforcing body matter more than the sophistication of the architecture.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess how the accountability of a digitally mediated adverse decision should be secured in...”, replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.